Sales Performance Dashboard

Project Report

- Tool: Microsoft Excel
- Dataset: Retail Sales Data (2014–2017)
- Prepared by: Aadil Fayaz

---

1. Business Problem

A retail company sells Furniture, Office Supplies, and Technology products across multiple US states. Its sales data is stored in a large dataset containing thousands of records, making it difficult for managers to quickly understand business performance. The company needs an interactive dashboard to analyze sales, profit, customer behaviour, product performance, and seasonal trends.

Business Questions

1. What are the total sales, total profit, and total number of sales records?
2. Which product sub-categories generate the highest sales?
3. How does profit change across categories over the years?
4. Which months have the highest sales?
5. Which states contribute the most sales?
6. Which customers generate the highest profit?
7. How does the number of unique customers change each year?

Problem Statement

To develop an interactive Excel dashboard that converts raw retail sales data into meaningful visual insights, enabling users to explore business performance using Category and Year slicers.

2. Project Objectives

- Display key performance indicators (KPIs), including Total Sales, Total Profit, and Total Records.
- Compare sales across product sub-categories and states.
- Analyze yearly profit trends across product categories.
- Identify monthly sales patterns and peak demand periods.
- Highlight the most profitable customers and yearly customer counts.
- Enable interactive filtering through Category and Year slicers.

3. Dataset Description

The dataset, salesdata.csv, contains approximately 9,993 sales records covering the period from 2014 to 2017. It includes information such as order dates, customer names, states, product categories, sales, quantity, and profit. The dataset was analyzed using Microsoft Excel to identify sales trends, product performance, profitability, and customer insights.

Note: *Since the dataset does not contain an Order ID field, 9,993 represents the number of sales records, not the number of unique orders.*

4. Tools and Methodology

The project was completed using Microsoft Excel through the following steps:

1. Imported the CSV dataset into Excel and formatted it as an Excel Table.
2. Created Year and Month helper columns from Order Date.
3. Built PivotTables to analyze sales, profit, customer counts, and product performance.
4. Created visualizations, including funnel, line, map, pie, bar, and area charts.

5. Added Category and Year slicers and connected them to the relevant PivotTables using Report Connections.
6. Designed KPI cards linked to PivotTable results to display updated values.
7. Applied a consistent purple and green theme and organized the visualizations on a single Dashboard worksheet.

5. Dashboard Overview

The Sales Performance Dashboard provides an interactive view of sales, profit, customer performance, and monthly trends. It uses KPI cards, charts, and Category and Year slicers to help users explore business performance.



Figure 1: *Sales Performance Dashboard developed using Microsoft Excel*

6. Key Insights

- Product Performance: Phones lead sales in Technology, Chairs lead sales in Furniture, and Storage leads sales in Office Supplies.
- Profit Trends: Technology shows strong profit growth over the analysed period, while Furniture requires closer examination of its profitability.
- Seasonality: Sales increase during September, November, and December, indicating stronger demand toward the end of the year.
- Geographical Performance: California and Texas are among the leading states in sales.
- Customer Growth: The reported yearly customer count decreases in 2015 before recovering in 2016 and 2017.
- Top Customers: Tamara Chand, Raymond Buch, Sanjit Chand, Hunter Lopez, and Adrian Barton are identified as the leading customers by profit.

Note: These findings should be verified against the final PivotTables and slicer selections before submission.

7. Business Recommendations

1. Review Furniture pricing, discounting, and product costs to identify opportunities to improve profitability.
2. Evaluate opportunities to support Technology products with strong profit performance.

3. Prepare inventory and staffing for higher-demand months, particularly toward the end of the year.
4. Consider targeted promotions during lower-sales periods to improve demand.
5. Analyze state-level performance to identify opportunities in both high-sales and low-sales markets.
6. Develop customer retention strategies for high-profit customers.

8. Limitations

- The dataset does not contain an Order ID column; therefore, the total record count cannot be treated as the number of unique orders.
- The analysis covers only the 2014–2017 period and may not represent current market conditions.
- The project focuses on descriptive analysis and does not include predictive forecasting.
- Business recommendations are based on historical patterns and should be validated before implementation.

9. Conclusion

The Sales Performance Dashboard transforms approximately 10,000 retail sales records into an interactive and easy-to-understand visual report. It provides insights into sales performance, profitability, product categories, customer behaviour, geographical trends, and monthly demand.

The analysis highlights the importance of monitoring product profitability, understanding seasonal demand, and identifying high-performing markets and customers. Category and Year slicers allow users to explore the data efficiently and support informed business decisions.

10. Skills Demonstrated

- Microsoft Excel
- PivotTables and PivotCharts
- Data Analysis and Visualization
- Interactive Dashboards and Slicers
- Excel Formulas
- Business Insights and Reporting